The Translator’s Software-Comparison Checklist

What a Bible translator checks before buying Bible-study software — category language, no product claims. Test any software yourself.

- [ ] **1. Original-language word study**
  Can I click any English word and see the underlying Hebrew or Greek — every occurrence, not just a dictionary gloss?

- [ ] **2. Interlinears and manuscript visibility**
  Can I read the original text line by line, and see where the manuscripts differ, without paying extra for each layer?

- [ ] **3. Trusted commentaries**
  Which scholars and commentaries are included, which cost extra, and can I test the ones I would actually cite?

- [ ] **4. Library portability**
  If I stop subscribing, what happens to the library I bought — what can I take with me, and what stays behind?

- [ ] **5. Trial availability**
  Can I test the full feature set before paying — free for weeks, not a three-day teaser?

- [ ] **6. Total cost of ownership**
  Subscription plus the add-ons I will actually need, over three years — the headline price is not the number that matters.

The rule of thumb

Do not compare brands — compare answers. Score each software on these six categories with your own hands-on test, and run at least two trials before you pay. A category that is paywalled is not a feature you can evaluate — treat it as untested.

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